



AKC CGC Prep

CGC Skill 2 · Polite Petting Practice Log



FITDOG TRAINING ACADEMY

Sitting Politely for Petting

Master cgc item 2.

Your dog sits calmly while a stranger pets their head and body. No mouthing, jumping, or shyness that prevents the evaluator from completing the exam.

TRAINER NOTE

CGC prep is about reliable real-life manners — not perfection under pressure. Practice below threshold, log your reps,

Start here

Dog's name

Target test date

Handler name

Best reward

Know the criteria

Dog sits politely for petting. Stranger pets head and body. Dog must show

1 **Official skill criteria**
no jumping or mouthing.

Handler mechanics

Cue sit before the stranger reaches.

End on success

Stop while your dog can still think, eat, and cooperate.

CGC ITEM 2

Dog sits politely for petting. Stranger pets head and body. Dog must show no shyness or resentment; no jumping or mouthing.

2 Handler checklist

- ☐ Cue sit before the stranger reaches.
- ☐ Feed low and slow while petting happens.
- ☐ Keep sessions short — 5–10 seconds of petting first.
- ☐ Shy dogs: let them sniff the stranger's hand first.

Supplies needed

- 6-ft leash
- Front-clip harness
- High-value treats



CGC PRACTICE · FITDOG

3 Step-by-step practice plan

Cue a sit. Have a helper approach and pet your dog's shoulder, then head.

Mark calm stillness. Feed low at your dog's chest between pets.

Increase petting duration from 2 seconds to 10 seconds over sessions.

Practice with different people, scents, and clothing.

Log whether your dog held sit without mouthing or jumping away.

4 Common reasons dogs fail this item

☐ Breaking sit to jump

☐ Mouthing the stranger's hand

☐ Moving away from touch

☐ Handler pulling dog into sit

5 Weekly practice log

Date	Setup	Duration	Success 1–5	Notes / next step
Day 1	Easy environment	5 min		
Day 2	Add one distraction	5 min		
Day 3	Hold difficulty	5 min		
Day 4	New location	5 min		
Day 5	Review + film	5 min		

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TEST DAY · READINESS

6 Test-day readiness checklist

FITDOG TRAINER HOMEWORK

Polite petting is a stay behavior with social pressure — build it slowly and reward stillness.

- ☐ Sit held 10+ sec with petting at home
- ☐ Three different helpers practiced
- ☐ Mouthy dogs fed between pets

7 Self-score before scheduling your evaluation

Question	Yes	Not yet
Dog succeeds 4/5 reps in practice this week		
Handler can explain criteria without reading notes		
Dog can eat treats in practice environment		
No safety concerns (bite risk, panic, escape)		
Ready to schedule official CGC evaluation		



Schedule evaluation — stack wins look solid



Another 2 weeks of practice at this skill



Contact Fitdog for trainer support

8 Notes for your trainer or evaluator

Observation	Details
Strongest rep this week	
Hardest moment	
Equipment that helped	
Question for test day	